How to Use Your ATS Resume Template

A one-page guide to filling in the template and getting past Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS).

HOW TO USE THE TEMPLATE

1. Open ATS-Resume-Template-Freshers.docx in Microsoft Word, Google Docs (File > Open > Upload) or LibreOffice Writer.
2. Replace every yellow-highlighted [PLACEHOLDER] with your own details. Search for "[" to make sure none are left.
3. Remove the highlight: select all text, then set highlight colour to "No colour".
4. Delete sections that do not apply to you (for example, Experience if you have none yet – move Projects up instead).
5. Keep it to one page if you have less than 3 years of experience.
6. Save as PDF unless the job post asks for .docx. Name the file clearly: Firstname-Lastname-Resume.pdf.

ATS TIPS THAT ACTUALLY MATTER

- **Match the job description.** Copy the exact skill names from the job post (e.g. "Bootstrap 5", not just "CSS frameworks") where they are true for you.
- **Keep standard headings.** Summary, Skills, Education, Experience, Projects. ATS software looks for these words.
- **Single column only.** No tables, text boxes, icons, photos or skill bars. Many ATS tools read these in the wrong order or skip them.
- **Use simple fonts.** Calibri, Arial or similar at 10.5–12 pt. Avoid putting key details in headers or footers.
- **Lead with action verbs and numbers.** Built, designed, improved, reduced, led. "Reduced load time by 30%" beats "worked on performance".
- **Write dates consistently.** Use one format, such as "Jun 2025 – Aug 2025", everywhere.
- **Tailor for every application.** Spend 10 minutes adjusting your Summary and Skills for each role. It is the highest-return habit in job hunting.
- **Check before you send.** Paste your resume into a plain text editor. If it reads cleanly top to bottom, an ATS can probably read it too.

QUICK FINAL CHECKLIST

☐ No [PLACEHOLDER] text or highlight left

☐ Email and phone number are correct

☐ Links work (LinkedIn, GitHub, portfolio)

☐ Spelling checked

☐ Saved as Firstname-Lastname-Resume.pdf